

attention enables feature learning between patches. For larger datasets, such as Traffic (~15 million) and Electricity (~8 million), a model named "LTrsf," using the encoder from CALF [21], performs better. In those methods, finally, time series embedding will be projected with a single linear layer to forecast. Details of other encoders is in Appendix subsection D.3.

Overall, patching plays a crucial role in encoding. Additionally, basic Attention and Transformer block also effectively aid in encoding.

5 Conclusion

In this paper we showed that despite the recent popularity of LLMs in time series forecasting they do not appear to meaningfully improve performance. We experimented with simple ablations, showing that they maintain or improve the performance of the LLM-based counterparts while requiring considerably less compute. Once more, our goal is not to suggest that LLMs have no place in time series analysis. To do so would likely prove to be a shortsighted claim. Rather, we suggest that the community should dedicate more focus to the exciting tasks could be unlocked by LLMs at the interface of time series and language such as time series reasoning [24, 7, 44, 36], or social understanding [6].

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